

INEQUALITIES

• **Elementary Results:**

- (1) If $a > b$ and $b > c$, then $a > c$.
- (2) In general if $a_1 > a_2, a_2 > a_3, a_3 > a_4, \dots, a_{n-1} > a_n$, then $a_1 > a_n$.
- (3) If $a > b$, then $a \pm c > b \pm c$.
- (4) If $a > b$ and $c > 0$, then $ac > bc$.
- (5) If $a > b$ and $c < 0$, then $ac < bc$.
- (6) If $a > b$ and $c > 0$, then $\frac{a}{c} > \frac{b}{c}$.
- (7) If $a > b$ and $c < 0$, then $\frac{a}{c} < \frac{b}{c}$.
- (8) If $a > b > 0$, then $\frac{1}{a} < \frac{1}{b}$.
- (9) If $a_i > b_i > 0, i = 1, 2, \dots, n$, then $a_1 a_2 a_3 a_4 \dots a_n > b_1 b_2 b_3 b_4 \dots b_n$.
- (10) If $0 < a < 1$ and r is positive real number, then $0 < a^r < 1 < \frac{1}{a^r}$.
- (11) If $a > 1$ and r is positive real number, then $a^r > 1 > \frac{1}{a^r}$.
- (12) If $0 < a < b$ and r is positive real number, then $a^r < b^r$.
- (13) If $0 < a < b$ and r is positive real number, then $\frac{1}{a^r} > \frac{1}{b^r}$.
- (14) If $0 < \frac{a}{b} < 1$ and r is positive real number, then $\left(\frac{a}{b}\right)^r < 1 < \left(\frac{b}{a}\right)^r$.
- (15) Triangle Inequality: $|a + b| \leq |a| + |b|$.
- (16) $|a_1 + a_2 + a_3 + \dots + a_n| \leq |a_1| + |a_2| + |a_3| + \dots + |a_n|$.
- (17) $|a| = \max\{a, -a\}$.
- (18) $-|a| \leq a \leq |a|, \quad \forall a \in R$.
- (19) If $b \geq 0$, then $|x - a| \leq b \Rightarrow a - b \leq x \leq a + b$.
- (20) If $a > 1$ and $x > y > 0$, then $\log_a x > \log_a y$.
- (21) If $0 < a < 1$ and $x > y > 0$, then $\log_a x < \log_a y$.

- **Relation between AM (A), GM (G) and HM (H):** Let $a_1, a_2, a_3, a_4, \dots, a_n$ are n number of positive real numbers then,

$$(1) \quad A = \frac{a_1 + a_2 + a_3 + \dots + a_n}{n}, \quad G = (a_1 a_2 a_3 \dots a_n)^{1/n}, \quad H = \frac{n}{\frac{1}{a_1} + \frac{1}{a_2} + \frac{1}{a_3} + \dots + \frac{1}{a_n}}.$$

$$(2) \quad A \geq G \geq H.$$

$$(3) \quad A, G \text{ and } H \text{ lie between the least and the greatest between } a_1, a_2, a_3, a_4, \dots, a_n.$$

- For n positive real numbers $a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots, a_n$ and n positive real numbers $w_1, w_2, w_3, \dots, w_n$, then

$$(1) \quad \text{Arithmetic Mean} = A_w = \frac{w_1 a_1 + w_2 a_2 + w_3 a_3 + \dots + w_n a_n}{w_1 + w_2 + w_3 + \dots + w_n}.$$

$$(2) \quad \text{Geometric Mean} = G_w = \left(a_1^{w_1} a_2^{w_2} a_3^{w_3} \dots a_n^{w_n} \right)^{\frac{1}{w_1 + w_2 + w_3 + \dots + w_n}}.$$

$$(3) \quad A_w \geq G_w.$$

$$(4) \quad A_w = G_w \text{ iff } a_1 = a_2 = a_3 = \dots = a_n.$$

- Cauchy-Schwarz Inequality:** For real numbers $a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots, a_n$ and $b_1, b_2, b_3, \dots, b_n$,
 $(a_1 b_1 + a_2 b_2 + a_3 b_3 + \dots + a_n b_n)^2 \leq (a_1^2 + a_2^2 + a_3^2 + \dots + a_n^2)(b_1^2 + b_2^2 + b_3^2 + \dots + b_n^2).$

The inequality hold iff $\frac{a_1}{b_1} = \frac{a_2}{b_2} = \frac{a_3}{b_3} = \dots = \frac{a_n}{b_n}.$

- Tchebychef Inequality:** For real numbers $a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots, a_n$ and $b_1, b_2, b_3, \dots, b_n$, such that $a_1 \leq a_2 \leq a_3 \leq \dots \leq a_n$ and $b_1 \leq b_2 \leq b_3 \leq \dots \leq b_n$, then

$$\frac{a_1 b_1 + a_2 b_2 + a_3 b_3 + \dots + a_n b_n}{n} \geq \frac{a_1 + a_2 + a_3 + \dots + a_n}{n} \times \frac{b_1 + b_2 + b_3 + \dots + b_n}{n}.$$

The inequality holds iff $a_1 = a_2 = a_3 = \dots = a_n$ or $b_1 = b_2 = b_3 = \dots = b_n.$

- Weierstrass' Inequality:**

(1) If $a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots, a_n$ are n positive real numbers, then for $n \geq 2$

$$(1 + a_1)(1 + a_2)(1 + a_3) \dots (1 + a_n) > 1 + a_1 + a_2 + a_3 + \dots + a_n$$

(2) If $a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots, a_n$ are n positive real numbers, then for $n < 1$

$$(1 - a_1)(1 - a_2)(1 - a_3) \dots (1 - a_n) > 1 - a_1 - a_2 - a_3 - \dots - a_n.$$

- Arithmetic Mean of m -th order:** Let $a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots, a_n$ are n positive real numbers (not all equal) and let m be a real number, then

$$(1) \quad \frac{a_1^m + a_2^m + a_3^m + \dots + a_n^m}{n} > \left(\frac{a_1 + a_2 + a_3 + \dots + a_n}{n} \right)^m \text{ if } m \in R - [0, 1].$$

$$(2) \quad \frac{a_1^m + a_2^m + a_3^m + \dots + a_n^m}{n} < \left(\frac{a_1 + a_2 + a_3 + \dots + a_n}{n} \right)^m \text{ if } m \in (0, 1).$$

$$(3) \quad \frac{a_1^m + a_2^m + a_3^m + \dots + a_n^m}{n} = \left(\frac{a_1 + a_2 + a_3 + \dots + a_n}{n} \right)^m \text{ if } m \in \{0, 1\}.$$

• **Logarithmic Inequality:**

- (1) $\log_{a^b} n = \frac{1}{b} \log_a n.$
- (2) $a^{\log_c b} = b^{\log_c a}$, where $a, b, c > 0, c \neq 1$.
- (3) Usually $\log a^n = n \log a$, but if n is even then $\log a^n = n \log |a|$.
- (4) If $a > 1, p > 1 \Rightarrow \log_a p > 0$.
- (5) If $0 < a < 1, p > 1 \Rightarrow \log_a p < 0$.
- (6) If $a > 1, 0 < p < 1 \Rightarrow \log_a p < 0$.
- (7) If $p > a > 1 \Rightarrow \log_a p > 1$.
- (8) If $a > p > 1 \Rightarrow 0 < \log_a p < 1$.
- (9) If $0 < a < p < 1 \Rightarrow 0 < \log_a p < 1$.
- (10) If $0 < p < a < 1 \Rightarrow \log_a p > 1$.
- (11) If $\log_m a > b \Rightarrow \begin{cases} a > m^b & m > 1 \\ a < m^b & 0 < m < 1 \end{cases}$.
- (12) If $\log_m a < b \Rightarrow \begin{cases} a < m^b & m > 1 \\ a > m^b & 0 < m < 1 \end{cases}$.
- (13) If $\log_m a < \log_m b \Rightarrow \begin{cases} a \geq b & p > 1 \\ a \leq b & 0 < p < 1 \end{cases}$.
